GRADE 12 / Life Orientation / English

Prepare for assessments sustainably

01 Understand

Learning goals: Use retrieval practice and feedback • Create a realistic revision cycle • Recognise when support is needed

Retrieval practice means trying to recall or apply knowledge before checking notes. Checking errors afterwards helps choose the next revision task.

A balanced revision plan rotates subjects, includes breaks and protects sleep. Long hours alone do not prove that learning has occurred.

Stress can affect concentration. Use practical supports and talk to a trusted adult or qualified professional when distress is persistent or interferes with daily life.

A repeatable revision cycle

Step	Action	Evidence
Recall	answer a short set without notes	your first attempt
Check	compare with a memo	identify the error type
Repair	rework and explain the correction	correct reasoning
Revisit	try again after a gap	independent recall

02 Follow the reasoning

A learner rereads notes for hours but struggles with questions. Suggest a stronger revision session.

1. Choose a short topic and attempt a few questions before looking at the notes.

2. Mark the attempt, classify errors as concept, calculation or interpretation, and explain one correction.

3. Return to a similar question after a gap and ask for help if the concept remains unclear.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Why is copying a memo not enough evidence of learning?

2. Name one adjustment that can reduce revision overload.

3. How can a learner use a teacher’s feedback?

04 Check and correct

1. It does not show that the learner can recall or apply the reasoning independently.
2. Reduce session length, prioritise a specific topic, schedule breaks or seek help planning.
3. Identify a specific recurring error, practise the relevant skill and check the improvement.

Common mistake to avoid

Peer advice and study plans do not replace professional support for persistent distress or significant health concerns.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Study skills: examination preparation and stress management

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: Life Orientation. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID lo-12.